From: Shirley Bennett
Sent: 8 Jun 2016 08:59:36 +0100
To: Scanning
Subject: FW: Planning Application Number S/OUT/13/1555 - South Marston & Rowborough

Kind Regards

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'NOTE: Swindon Borough Council has an adopted and published Community Infrastructure Levy Charging Schedule. The Charging Schedule becomes effective from **6th April 2015**. For information on how this may affect your development proposal please visit www.swindon.gov.uk/cil'

From: Simon Olive [mailto:[redacted]
Sent: 07 June 2016 8:47 PM
To: SBC Development Control
Subject: Planning Application Number S/OUT/13/1555 - South Marston & Rowborough

Dear Sir / Madam,

Further to the recent outline planning application referred to above I have a couple of significant points I would like to make, which relate to road systems and water drainage.

Firstly you may wish to note I live at 3 Manor Cottages, Old Vicarage Lane, South Marston SN3 4SS. As a household that flooded in 2007 and experienced a number of close calls over the years since I have frequently been involved in discussions about the development with the Parish Council and been on the Working Party, met a few times with the Environment Agency and Council members etc.

Drainage

- Given the feedback over the years of how the water flows at pace down the old original iron age drain across the field opposite our house, I am astounded to see the developers proposing putting a relief road that will cut across this drainage route a couple of times. (I for one thought this drain was protected)
- I am equallly perturbed to see that with housing proposed in the field to our right and to our left, there is no additional and immediate additional sub urban

drainage facility between those two clusters of houses in the field opposite us. Currently the addition of housing to our right and left will further divert water directly and more quickly onto the frontages of Manor Cottages. The idea of an allotment here is also quite amusing unless residents wants to grow rice!

- I would therefore propose that this field does not accommodate the relief road and the natural drain is left open and more of this field is utilised for additional natural water storage.
- In general I have concerns that the drainage systems in place are erring too close to the minimum they can get away with, particularly with the scale of the development proposed on the top of the hill sending water down into the valley and brook. Developers should show willing and have in place far more substantial drainage provision than is apparent.

Roads

- Apart from my comment on the relief road in addition I have huge concern about the road proposals eminating from Rowborough linking to Old Vicarage Lane. I have always maintained that a completely new and separate access out of Rowborough needs to be in place as a pre-requisite to the development of Rowborough - unless the development was anything other than a couple of hundred more exclusive homes. I see no reason for two roads onto Old Vicarage Lane if the plan is to have a new route onto the A420.
- The Rowborough development should not be able to start or at least progress beyond a couple of hundred homes without the new access onto the A420 being "in place". With the scale of the proposed development this should not make the overall plan unviable, just planned and funded more carefully. Protecting the environment and accessibility for existing and future residents of South Marston is important and the potential for any scale development to happen at Rowborough without this being done (not promised, but actually in place is crucial)
- The traffic light concept onto the A420 under the railway near the Carpenters Arms is laughable - well it certainly will be if Rowborough homes are accessing this exit route. There will be traffic jams all the way back into Rowborough and up Old Vicarage Lane - it will be an economic and environmental disaster, not to mention exacerbate the dangers to children and pedestrains up in the heart of the village and around Pound Corner!

I am not opposed to development, just please, please do it right and ensure developers don't cut corners as it is not they who have to live with the consequences. South Marston is named as such because it is old Marsh Land hence drainage is critical - the railway line is an obstacle and if developers say that to build under it is un-economical then they may need to consider alternative sites, plan a totally different exit route across the top of the hillside towards Highworth and Superrmarine or change their ideas on the scale of the development and look at a more exclusive set of multi million pound homes etc. Just because they can't or "won't find a way to" afford the correct solution does not

mean that all the residents of South Marston have to pay the price for the rest of their years living in the Village.

Thanking you in anticipation

Kind regards

Simon Olive [redacted]